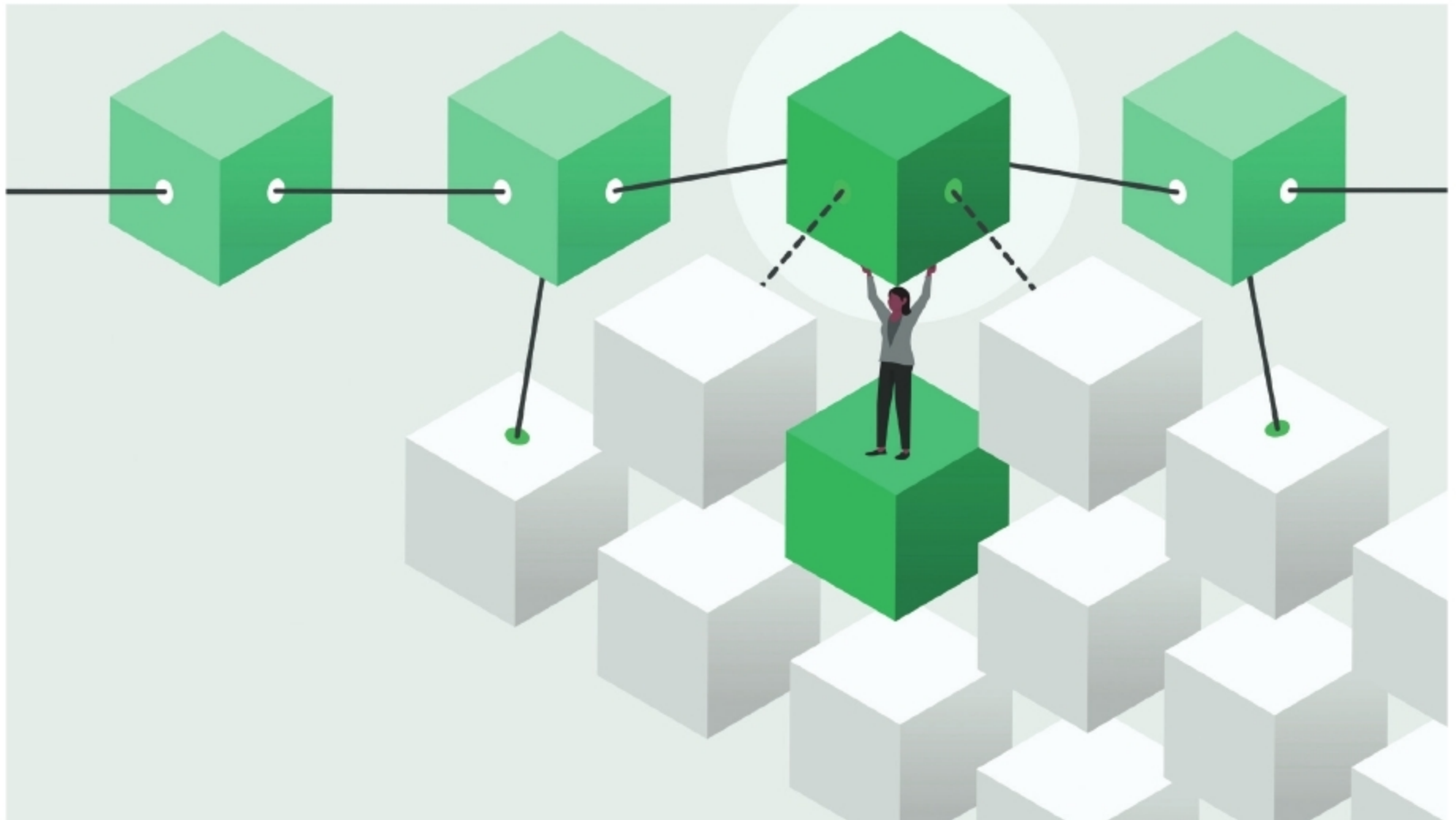


# An Introduction to Solidity, the Language that Runs Ethereum

Solidity is an object-oriented, statically typed, high-level scripting language for implementing smart contracts, which are programs that govern the behaviour of accounts within the Ethereum state. Learn more about Solidity in this article.



**S**olidity is a contract-based, advanced programming language. Its syntax is very similar to that of scripting languages like JavaScript. It was built to run the Ethereum blockchain platform and was shaped by existing languages — C++, Python and JavaScript, and is primarily designed to allow smart contracts to be created in the network. Solidity is a statically typed scripting language that verifies and enforces the constraints at compile-time as opposed to run-time.

Solidity uses a vast number of programming concepts from other languages. For example, it has variables, string manipulation, classes, functions, arithmetic operations and so on. While in a language like C, a programmer would be likely to create some form of a function, like ‘int main’ and ‘main’, Solidity works with a ‘contract’ that is created in an analogous manner. The Solidity programming language looks surprisingly similar to C++, C#, or JavaScript. Python developers will note that in Solidity, variables need their type to be explicitly declared, along with other differences.

## The origins of Solidity

Computer scientist Gavin Wood originally came up with the concept of the Solidity language. Wood served as the CTO at Ethereum for two years. His idea was taken forward by Christian Reitwiessner, who led a team of people to actually develop it.

A brief history is given below.

- August 2014: The Solidity language is proposed by Gavin Wood.
- October 2014: Solidity is adopted as a language by Monax, a rival platform.
- August 2015: Solidity is officially released.

## Is it worth learning Solidity?

While learning blockchain related skills can be highly valuable, one would probably need to become an expert first in at least one other programming language. If you feel confident in dedicating a few years of your life to learning Solidity, give it a try. It’s quite possible that you will have a reliable, stable career for years to come. In addition to Solidity, there